

# Email Threat Intelligence & Forensic Report

Generated: 2026-08-27 12:37:20 UTC | Scan ID: scan\_994afa14f612 | File: phishing\_ceo\_fraud.eml

100/100  
MALICIOUS

**Executive Summary:**

CRITICAL THREAT: This email exhibits multiple high-confidence indicators of phishing, domain spoofing, or malware delivery. Do not open attachments or click links.

## 1. Header & Identity Metadata

|                   |                                                                            |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Subject:          | URGENT: Immediate Action Required - Confidential Acquisition Wire Transfer |
| From:             | Apple Executive Office <tim.cook@apple-executive-support.xyz>              |
| To:               | victim@company.com                                                         |
| Date:             | Thu, 27 Aug 2026 09:15:00 +0000                                            |
| Return-Path:      | bounce-handler@random-spammer-relay.xyz                                    |
| Originating IP:   | 185.220.101.5                                                              |
| Total Relay Hops: | 1                                                                          |

## 2. Email Authentication Matrix

| Protocol                          | Header Result | DNS Record Discovered              |
|-----------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------|
| SPF (Sender Policy Framework)     | FAIL          | No published SPF TXT record        |
| DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail) | FAIL          | No DKIM signature found            |
| DMARC (Domain-based Auth)         | FAIL          | No published DMARC record (_dmarc) |

## 3. Explainable Risk Signals Triggered

| Signal Name                                           | Category       | Severity | Weight | Description                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SPF Authentication Softfail                           | AUTHENTICATION | MEDIUM   | +15    | The sending domain discourages this host from sending mail (~all policy).                                                                                                   |
| DKIM Cryptographic Signature Invalid                  | AUTHENTICATION | HIGH     | +25    | DKIM signature check failed; email body or headers may have been modified in transit.                                                                                       |
| DMARC Policy Alignment Failed                         | AUTHENTICATION | CRITICAL | +30    | Email failed DMARC validation against the sender domain's published security policy.                                                                                        |
| Header Domain Mismatch (From vs Return-Path/Reply-To) | SPOOFING       | HIGH     | +25    | From domain (apple-executive-support.xyz) != Return-Path domain (random-spammer-relay.xyz); From domain (apple-executive-support.xyz) != Reply-To domain (darkweb-mail.top) |

|                                                             |                  |          |     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| High IP Abuse Score (88%) on AbuseIPDB                      | THREAT_INTEL     | CRITICAL | +35 | The originating IP (185.220.101.5) has 142 recorded abuse reports for spam/malware/attacks.                                                                                                                                                               |
| Sender Domain Flagged Malicious on VirusTotal (9 engines)   | THREAT_INTEL     | CRITICAL | +40 | Domain 'apple-executive-support.xyz' is identified as malicious by security vendors.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Raw IP Address Used in Hyperlink                            | CONTENT_ANALYSIS | HIGH     | +20 | Hyperlink points directly to an IP address instead of a legitimate registered domain name.                                                                                                                                                                |
| Deceptive Hyperlink Anchor Text                             | CONTENT_ANALYSIS | HIGH     | +25 | Visual anchor text shows one URL while the underlying hyperlink directs the user to a completely different domain.                                                                                                                                        |
| Social Engineering & Urgency Indicators Detected            | CONTENT_ANALYSIS | MEDIUM   | +15 | Trigger phrases detected: immediately action required, wire transfer                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| AI Intent Flag: CEO Fraud / Business Email Compromise (BEC) | AI_INTENT        | HIGH     | +20 | The email exhibits traits of **CEO Fraud / Business Email Compromise (BEC)**. The attacker utilizes psychological manipulation strategies involving **Artificial Urgency, Financial Bait / Wire Request, Secrecy & Isolation** to pressure the recipient. |

4. Threat Intelligence & IP Geolocation

|                          |                                                                       |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Origin Location:         | Brandenburg an der Havel, Brandenburg, Germany (DE)                   |
| ISP / Autonomous System: | Stiftung Erneuerbare Freiheit (AS60729 Stiftung Erneuerbare Freiheit) |
| Coordinates (Lat, Lon):  | 52.6171, 13.1207                                                      |
| AbuseIPDB Confidence:    | 88% (Reports: 142)                                                    |
| VirusTotal Domain Flag:  | 9 malicious / 90 engines (Reputation: -30)                            |

5. Extracted Links & Defanged URL Forensics

| Defanged Destination URL                               | Anchor Text                                         | Security Flags                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| hxxp[ ://]185[.]220[.]101[.]5/apple-verify/login[.]php | https://secure.apple.com/corporate-acquisition-wire | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Raw IP address used as URL host (High Risk)</li><li>Mismatched anchor text: Visual 'https://secure.apple.com/corporate-acquisition-wire' differs from actual destination '185.220.101.5'</li></ul> |